Galatians

Rescued by grace · Rooted in Christ · Session 1

THE LETTER AT A GLANCE

Paul writes to churches in Galatia facing a question that reaches into our lives: Is Christ's saving work sufficient, or must we add something to be accepted by God? The letter addresses Gentile inclusion, circumcision, God's promise, and life in the Spirit. God's law and Jewish identity are not the enemy; Paul challenges added requirements as the basis of righteousness before God.

Chapters 1–2: the gospel received and defended. Chapters 3–4: faith, promise, law, and inheritance. Chapters 5–6: freedom, the Spirit, and faithful life together.

READ TOGETHER — GALATIANS 1:1–9 CSB

1 Paul, an apostle—not from men or by man, but by Jesus Christ and God the Father who raised him from the
dead— 2 and all the brothers who are with me: To the churches of Galatia.

3 Grace to you and peace from God the Father and our Lord Jesus Christ, 4 who gave himself for our sins to
rescue us from this present evil age, according to the will of our God and Father. 5 To him be the glory forever and
ever. Amen.

6 I am amazed that you are so quickly turning away from him who called you by the grace of Christ and are
turning to a different gospel— 7 not that there is another gospel, but there are some who are troubling you and
want to distort the gospel of Christ.

8 But even if we or an angel from heaven should preach to you a gospel contrary to what we have preached to
you, a curse be on him! 9 As we have said before, I now say again: If anyone is preaching to you a gospel contrary
to what you received, a curse be on him!

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Grace Begins with Jesus

Part 1 · Galatians 1:1–5

RECEIVE HIS RESCUE

Paul begins with God's action. His apostolic commission comes from Jesus Christ and the Father who raised Jesus from the dead. Grace and peace come from this same God. Our hope begins with the crucified and risen Jesus, rather than a verdict we reach by comparing ourselves with someone else.

Jesus gives himself for our sins to rescue us. Sin is real, and grace does not ask us to hide or minimize it. Christ acts on our behalf, bearing what we could not resolve for ourselves. The Father's will stands behind this rescue, and God receives the glory. Through faith in Christ, we receive what we cannot earn.

Another woman's apparent confidence does not make Jesus less sufficient for you. A difficult week does not make his grace a reward reserved for people with a stronger story. Learning from someone's faith can be a gift; using her story to measure your standing before God shifts your confidence away from Christ.

As we receive grace together, we can listen before offering advice, welcome honest questions, and encourage one another from Scripture. Faithful growth matters. It grows from Christ's rescue rather than completing it.

DISCUSS

1. How would you explain the gospel to someone who asked what you believe? How do Jesus' resurrection and self-giving in 1:1–5 shape your answer?
2. How does Christ's rescue encourage you, and how does it challenge a comparison or expectation that can shape your sense of belonging?

NOTES AND REFLECTION

Guarding the Gospel

Part 2 · Galatians 1:6–9

KEEP CHRIST AT THE CENTER

Paul is alarmed that the churches are turning from the God who calls them in grace. The altered message is not another legitimate gospel. It changes the foundation on which people trust God. In Galatia, requirements imposed on Gentile believers, including circumcision, were being made necessary for righteousness before God.

We can also turn good things into added conditions of acceptance. Service, prayer, and faithful responsibility are good. But if being useful, always sounding assured, or keeping up with someone else becomes the reason God should accept us, our confidence has moved away from Christ's sufficient work.

The same gospel judges every messenger, even Paul himself. A confident voice or an appealing message cannot make a contrary gospel true. Ask what a teaching says Christ has accomplished and what it makes the basis of our confidence before God. Bring its claims back to Scripture.

The warning in verses 8–9 is serious and belongs to God's judgment. It calls us to care about truth and the people affected by it. We can examine harmful teaching patiently, welcome difficult questions, and encourage a faithful next step without making ourselves the measure of someone else's worth.

DISCUSS

1. Where might approval, comparison, visible usefulness, or appearing spiritually confident become an extra condition for feeling accepted by God? How would you test that expectation against 1:3–5?
2. How could taking gospel truth seriously change one way you speak to yourself or encourage another woman this week?

PRACTICE THIS WEEK

Reread Galatians 1:1–9. When comparison becomes a measure of your standing with God, name it in prayer and return to Christ's action. Offer someone a word of truthful encouragement grounded in grace, without comparing her with another person.

PRAY

Father, thank you for your grace through Jesus. Bring us back to Christ when approval or comparison becomes our measure of worth. Help us receive his rescue, discern what is true, and encourage one another with grace and truth. By your Spirit, form us in love and faithful trust. Amen.